

Veritigo

No 836 April 2020



NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB

Wellington Section Monthly Bulletin

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SPECIAL
COVID-19
EDITION

All humans must stay in doors.
All humans must self isolaaaaaaate. By order of the Daleks ...
Photo: Martin Godwin/The Guardian [More here](#)

Chair's Report

April 2020

Learning from the past

What have you learned in the past couple of months? Most likely you have learned that things have played out more or less as you thought they would. Is that right?

Now we have a new definition for Eliminate. No longer does it mean (according to Websters) 'put an end to', 'get rid of.' It seems to have replaced 'reduce' in the dictionary. What will 'reduce' do now, become 'maintain'? Who cares, we can go to the beach again and rugby is coming back. What happened to all the doom and gloom about how the world will never be the same? The Covidiot's think it was all an overreaction. You can see them in the street, out walking with their dogs, hogging the footpath, standing next to you in the supermarket. OK, so they are mostly millennials, but not all of them. I've seen a share of boomers out there glaring at me for crossing the road, even some OHPs - it might happen to others but it won't happen to me. Do you know of anyone who has died of Covid-19? I know of three. How many people do you know who died of the flu in the past ten years? I don't know any. But we're all good now right. Right?

What do we know from the past?

In 1918, during the Spanish flu, the communities that locked down early, hard and longest did best and rose again to be stronger, economically and socially. What is the best predictor of the future? It's the past. What have we learned from the past? That it's doomed to repeat itself. Don't become a statistic, or get close enough to make someone else one.

Stay home, stay safe and let's get back to global warming.

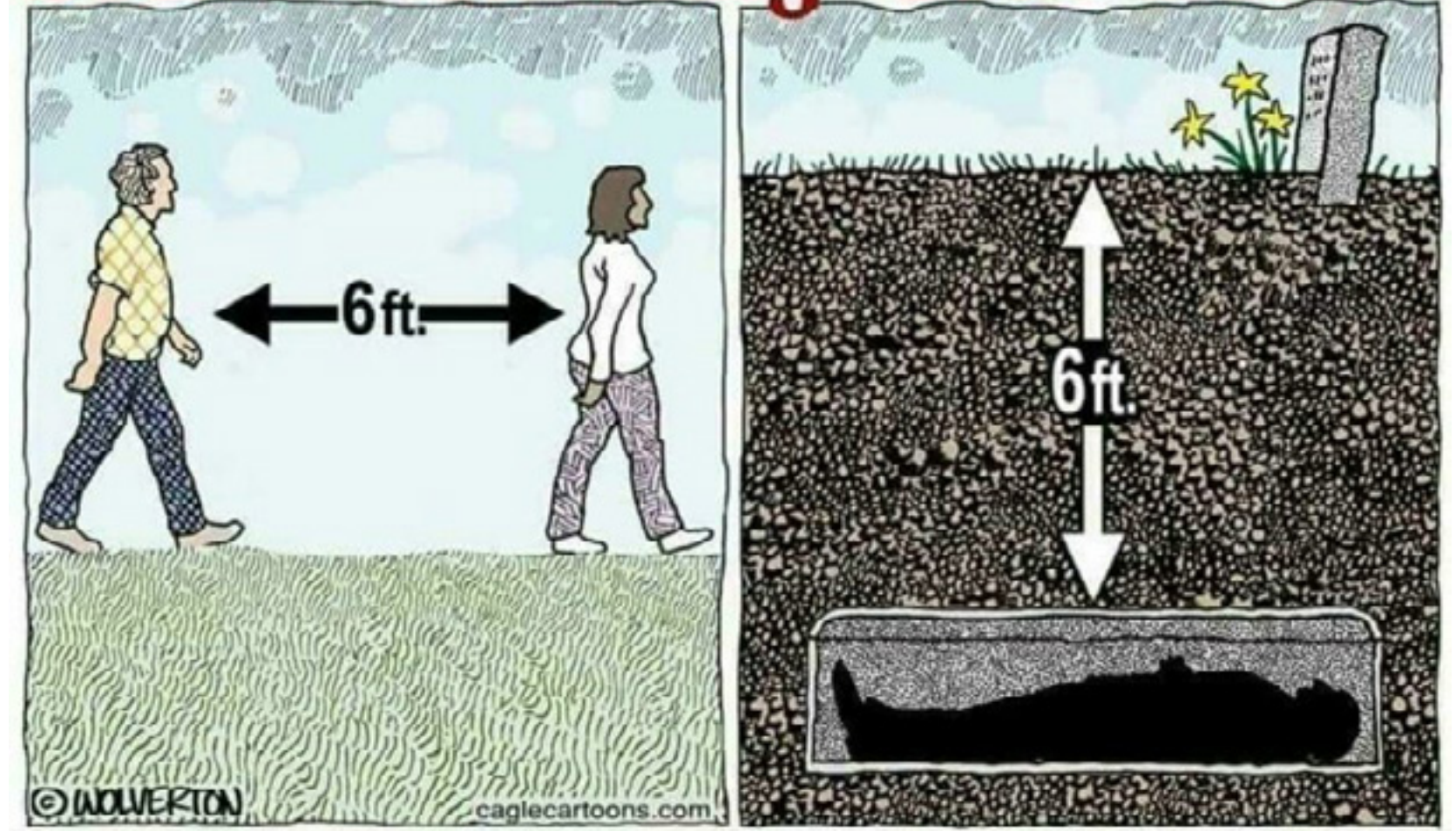
'Apathy is as dangerous, invisible and contagious as an asymptomatic virus carrier'. Khang Kijarro Nguyen

'You can revive an economy but not a corpse.' Abahijit Naskar

Any comments on what you like or don't like send an email to wellington@alpineclub.org.nz or tweet us @NZACWellington.



Social Distancing—Your Choice



From the editor

Yes, I know, the cover shot for April is a bit dark, but as a Doctor Who fan I couldn't resist. Do check out the [linked movie clip](#). At least we're now at Level 3 and new infections are virtually non-existent according to the testing results. May this be the only Vertigo ever published during 'lockdown'. Fingers crossed!

Unsurprisingly, there are no trip reports in this edition. Anything very recent would be somewhat of an own goal. But hopefully that will change again soon. In the meantime, we have some interesting 'from the bubble' items for you to read about Committee members' favourite outdoor gear. Mine is my altimeter, currently contained within my Garmin watch. I love to know how high I am and how long it's taken me to get there. For the past five or so weeks I've maintained an altitude of 250m above sea level, regularly rising to just over 300m on the Te Ahumairangi Walkway.

Also updates on trip and course status.

Stay safe and stay tuned ...



Simon Williamson
Outgoing Chair: NZAC Wellington

Section News

Gear Hire

The Section has gear for hire: avalanche transceivers, ice axes, shovels, stakes, hammers, helmets, crampons, probes, PLBs, ice hammers (entry level). Each item costs \$5 per week with the exception of PLBs – PLBs are free but require a deposit of \$50 refundable on return. To hire gear please fill in the form [here](#). You can find out more from [Carolyn](#).

Some advance notice, especially over the Christmas period, is appreciated as gear is in higher demand and often needs to be retrieved from the gear store. To collect or return your gear liaise with Genevieve.

InReach for hire



We suggest that all climbing parties carry a PLB as well as the InReach. If there is demand the section will purchase another one or two. The benefit of the InReach is that you can send and receive text messages, receive weather forecasts, and send an SOS in an emergency.

The InReach comes with 3 preset messages: 1. Delayed but everything is ok; 2. Starting our trip now; 3. This is where we are. Messages received from the InReach include a link that can be used to see the location. When hiring the InReach you need to provide an email address that will receive the messages and also advise if you'd like to adjust the preset messages.

The InReach can be paired using bluetooth to a Smartphone which has the Earthmate app loaded. This makes it much easier to type in messages. We recommend that you take a powerpack to keep the device charged and also only turn the InReach on when you need to use it to save battery power.

There's a \$50 deposit for hiring the InReach and a hire charge of \$20 / week-end. Additional charges will be incurred if you request weather forecasts or use non-preset messaging. [Contact Carolyn](#) kaz1963@gmail.com to find out more.

Discounted PLBs

skippersmate.co.nz offers a 5% discount to all NZAC members for NZ purchases of PLBs. Two brands are on offer - KTI SA2G and McMurdo Fast Find 220 (not always in stock). To use the discount, the coupon code on the website is **NZAC05** and the owner, Peter, asks you to send a copy of your membership card to peter@cooeebay.com

Section nights

Our Commmitte has decided that our Section nights must be suspended until such time it is judged that gatherings of people do not present an unacceptable health threat any longer. When that is no-one yet knows, but we will keep you posted. When the situation permits, we will advise Section night resumption.

In the meantime, online Section evenings are on the way ...

We will provide details and a link soon via separate email to an online presentation by Jo Morgan about her climbs in New Zealand's 3,000ers.

We also have Paul Maxim still pencilled in to present his recent climbing in the European Alps, including Mont Blanc. Whether this is online or in person remains to be seen.

Change of (future) venue

Even if Covid 19 had not emerged, due to a change in their pricing policy, our last Section night at The Third Eye, Tuatara Brewery was to be 24th March. And from April on our venue would have reverted to the Guest Room at the Southern Cross Tavern, 39 Abel Smith Street, from 6pm. We shifted from this venue before because our then Wednesday evening time slot clashed with live band performances, which made hearing difficult. This is no longer an issue so, when our Section nights do eventually resume, we will be able to once again enjoy a good space and food and beverages.

If you would like to make a presentation at a future Section night, or have a suggestion about someone else to present, please let Peter know - occasionalclimber@gmail.com.



The Guest Room, Southern Cross Tavern

Notices

A cool story

Section Committee member Guy Dubuis shares '[No pain, no gain: Para-climber Rachel Mãia 12 months on from leg amputation](#)'

TABLELAND ... the history behind Mount Arthur

Promising to be a much-loved reference work, as well as a beautifully illustrated coffee table book. To be printed in June, and on the bookshelves by October 2020. [Sign up](#) to the book's website to get an earlybird discount plus go in to a lucky to draw win a free book.

More secondhand books from NZAC's store available [here](#).

More copies of Summits and Shadows by Graham Langton available [here](#). Proceeds are being donated back to the Club's DOW Hall Fund.

The Summit of Her Ambition: The Spirited Life of Marie Byles 1900-1979 Now available [here](#).

The Earle Riddiford Collection

Gifted to the Alexander Turnbull Library, see more [here](#).

Recycling ideas

Find out about NZAC's recycling efforts and ideas [here](#).

Backcountry Hut Passes can be extended

Customers who have purchased Backcountry Hut Passes are eligible for extensions on their pass. Passes will be extended by the length of time that huts remain closed. For example, if an annual pass had 3 months until expiry from 23 March 2020 (the date backcountry huts closed), the customer may request a new expiry date of 3 months from the date that the huts are opened again. To access the extension, customers will need to take their pass to a DOC Visitor Centre, where they will be issued with a new pass with an extended expiry date. This will only be possible once the COVID-19 Alert Level has reduced and Visitor Centres have reopened.

More NZAC member discounts

New or recently renewed discounts:

Go Native - details [here](#).

Monster Merinos - details [here](#).

Outfitter - details [here](#).

An online discount code is viewable to members only once logged in.

All other discounted providers to NZAC members [here](#).

Indian Mountaineering Federation subscription offer

Over the next few weeks, regular Webinar videos will be uploaded on YouTube, starting with Volume 1 of the IMF Webinar Series titled Zemu Gap from South (Sikkim Himalaya - Kanchenjunga) by Anindya Mukherjee, which is [now live here](#).



Hey kids!

My name is Tara, and I'm a black-billed gull tarāpuka. In 2014 my gecko friend Moko plus 100 Canterbury kids aged 5 to 18 wrote a 250-page book about biodiversity.

As we all have to stay at home for a while, we teamed up with Trustpower so kids of all ages can have some creative fun & share what you discover about our amazing braided rivers that my friends and I call home.

Use your imagination, get inspiration from Moko's book, find heaps of resources on this website to create a picture, cartoon, story or something else, send it to us and thanks to Trustpower, you'll go into the draw* to WIN goodies weekly* and a very cool mystery prize in the final draw, plus we'll showcase your work on Facebook and our website.

See www.braideddrivers.org/kids for details

Trustpower

BRAID
Braided River Aid
www.braideddrivers.org



The Kanchenjunga massif from Pelling in Sikkim Photo: Peter Laurenson
[More here.](#)

Coming Trips, Courses, Events

Covid 19 impact

Until internal travel for leisure is officially deemed acceptable again we can not offer any trips.

Whenever that does happen, all our South Island trips come with the added bonus that rental vehicle costs for Wellington Section members are covered by the Section.

If you're uncertain about the skill level required with any of the trips, would like to register your interest or to find out more, email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Also, please contact us if you're keen to run a trip yourself – the Committee can help with advertising and logistics.

When	What and where
10 - 14 April	Mount Somers Rock Climbing Trip Cancelled.
29 May - 1 June	Flock Hill bouldering On hold. New dates to be advised when appropriate. Contact ericduggan@gmail.com
17 and 24 June	Banff Mountain film Festival 2020 Cancelled.
24 - 26 July 31 July - 2 August 14 - 16 August 21 - 23 August	2020 Snowcraft courses Still open, to be reassessed late June. Contact Nish Shah catchnishie@gmail.com Please note: a compulsory theory night for participants is on the Thursday night two weeks prior to each course. Participants will need to take the Friday afternoon off work to travel to the course venue.

NZAC instruction courses

Click for more details [Ice Climbing](#) [Ski Touring](#) [High Alpine Skills](#)

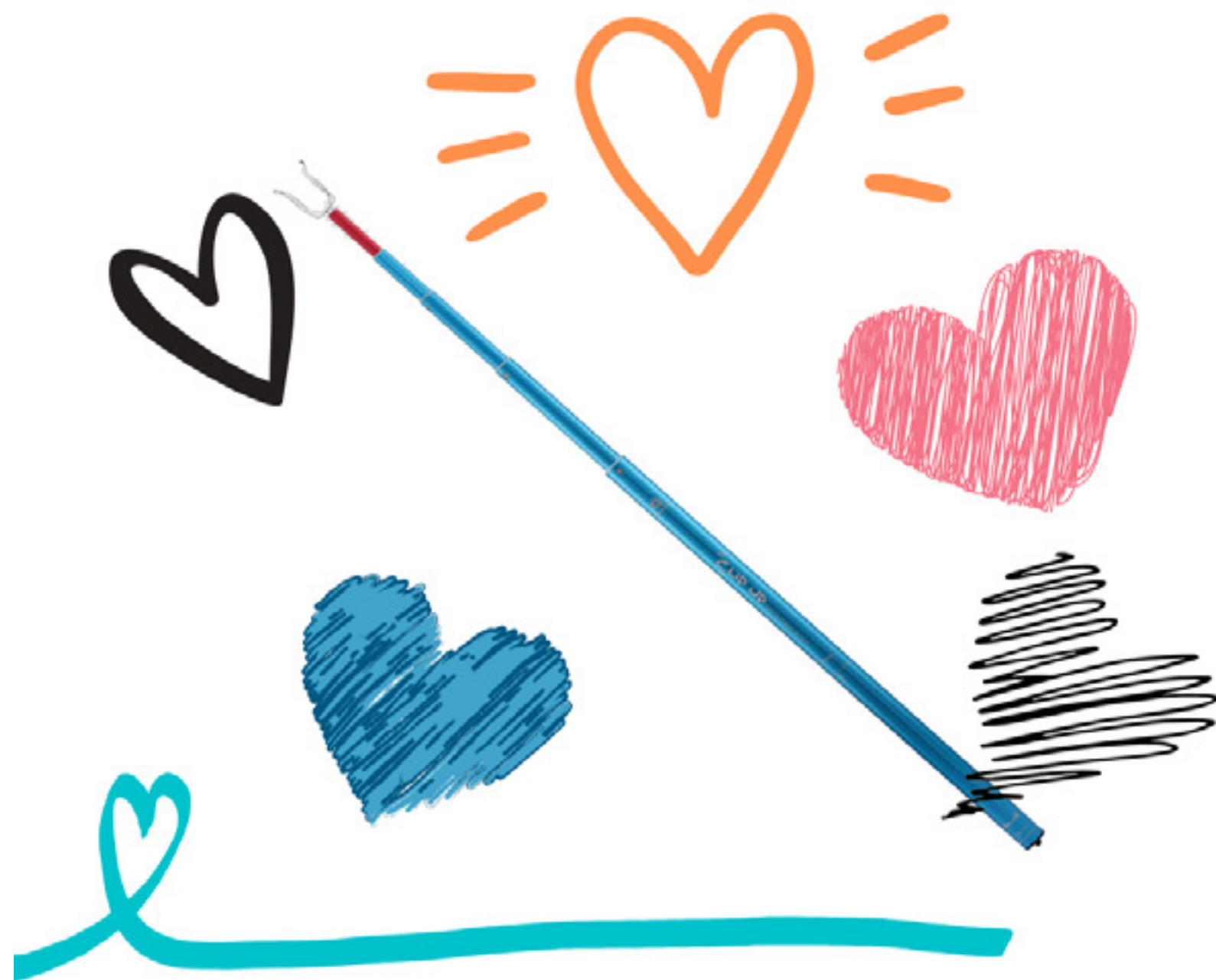


Gear Freaks

Stacey's Ode to the Stickclip

When the first bolt is way too high,
and you like your ankles so.
Plus the opening moves look too damn hard,
and you think...hell no.

When you've bitten off more than you can chew,
and you think you'll have to bail.
Stick clip to the top brother,
that shit will never fail.



[Buy a Stickclip here.](#)

Keith's favourite pack

Thinking about my favourite kit made me reflect on my first pack. A large heavy canvas bag on an external steel frame made by McGraths in Dunedin and given to me in my early teens. From tramping in the Silver Peaks behind Dunedin to deer stalking in the Southern Alps, it served me well. More character building than comfortable, however.

Many packs have come and gone since. I still have two Macpac day packs from the 1980s. They rate highly, partly because they are still going. Straps and buckles have fallen off or worn out and credit to Macpac, repairs have been prompt and reasonably priced. The pack fabric soldiers on. Recently, Jon Podge did a fine job of the latest tidy up of the Macpac Greenstone. (I tried strapping my skis on and tore the strap off. Not surprising since the strap is only expected to hold an ice axe.) If you live in or near Wellington, I highly recommend Jon if you need to repair or upgrade a pack (laplodge@gmail.com).

Moving into ski touring, I bought a special purpose Osprey pack. Unfortunately it looked bigger on the internet than in real life. What does 16L mean? It can't mean litres as this little fellow can't carry four litres of milk, not even the Lite stuff. Once my lunch is in, there's not much room for anything else. Part of the problem is, with so much space taken up with pockets, there's limited room for content like a shovel.

Back to the drawing board. I want a pack that's big enough to carry lunch, a shovel and sometimes a sleeping bag, bivy bag and toothbrush. And carry my skis. And its got to last forever. I settled on Cactus's Hector. 65L means it can be day or multi day. At its core it is a thick canvas bag. I'm trading weight for robustness and longevity. However, it is more than that - its a lovely engineered piece of kit. Very comfortable to wear and the overall configuration has everything, including two handy sized pockets. Not sure I will need to detach the detachable lid. Great warranty and guarantee (Cactus must believe their stuff is durable) and made in New Zealand.



Reflecting on favourite packs, I note 4 out of 5 were New Zealand made. We don't need to compromise to buy local. Just saying.

Section Contacts

Powered by volunteers

We're always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. A lot goes on to keep our club going, virtually all powered by volunteers. On the back page is our "Club on a page" summary. It gives an at a glance description of all the things we do, how and why. Feel free to print a copy and pass it on to anyone who might be interested in becoming a member or volunteer. And if you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Role	Name	Contact
Outgoing Chair, course coordinator	Simon Williamson	021 054 7684
Treasurer	Eva Duncan	evaduncan@windowslive.com
Secretary, club liaison	Keith Munro	keithm@mtgelab.co.nz
Gear custodian	Carolyn Ellis	021 574 287
Trip co-ordinator	Stacey Wong	staceycolleena@gmail.com
Section nights, Vertigo, Banff	Peter Laurensen	occasionalclimber@gmail.com
Banff	Emma Hayward	emmahayward@windowslive.com
Photo comp	Guy Dubuis	guy.dubuis@gmail.com
Social media	Rosie Percival	calicoanne@gmail.com
Reel Rock	Naomi Seow	naomiseow@gmail.com
Social media	Derek Cheng	derekcheng.nz@gmail.com
Patron	John Nankervis	
Rock drill overseer	Jeremy Tries	027 555 5893

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8 new boulders every week*

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hangdog.co.nz

* On average. Climbing competitions can interrupt our schedule.



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*Annual returns after fees as at 30th April 2019.

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Keith Munro
Registered Financial Adviser
027 654 6568
keithm@mtgelab.co.nz



Past performance is not necessarily a guide to future performance.

Our club on a page

WELLINGTON SECTION



NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB



WHAT WE DO

FOR MEMBERS

Facilities

- * Huts
- * Gear
- * Library
- * Discounts

Training

- * Level 1-3 winter skills
- * Summer rock
- * Instructors

Climbing trips

- * Section
- * National
- * International

FOR MEMBERS AND WIDER PUBLIC

Publications

- * Website
- * Social media
- * Vertigo
- * Guide books

Events

- * Banff mountain film festival
- * Reel Rock
- * Photo comp

Networking

- * Section nights
- * Conferences and meetings
- * Lobbying

HOW WE DO IT

Organise, encourage, support, enable

Inform, entertain, promote

OUR RESOURCES

Volunteer time and capabilities, income from events and gear hire, national office support, sponsorship

WHY WE DO IT

Connecting & developing more climbing & mountaineering people, knowledge, skills & experience, thereby ...

... building
lifelong
friendships

... protecting
and improving
access to
alpine places

... sustaining
and growing
climbing and
mountaineering
achievement

... enhancing
alpine
safety

... building
appreciation,
enjoyment and
protection of
alpine places

Image and diagram Peter Laurenson www.occasionalclimber.co.nz